CLEAN SLATE

Complete concept and conversation handoff | November 5, 2026

Purpose: This document captures the full idea as developed through discussion, including the founder's clarifications and the reasons behind the unusual Go Back feature. It is a concept explanation for review with Claude, not an instruction to redesign the product or begin implementation.

Central premise: A person can desperately want to remove an ex from everyday digital life while still hoping, however faintly, that the relationship might return. Clean Slate serves both impulses: immediate distance and the possibility of later restoration.

1. Original app idea

Clean Slate is an app for people experiencing a difficult breakup. Its original vision is to go through a phone's libraries and deeply buried media or attachments and remove everything associated with a former romantic partner. Examples include pictures, videos, conversations, saved files, attachments and overlooked digital reminders. The goal is to spare a user from repeatedly encountering memories of an ex and from the tedious process of hunting them down individually.

The initial concept envisioned artificial intelligence searching for and cleaning up this content. Later discussion introduced an equally valid non-AI path in which the user finds and submits content themselves, guided by the app.

2. Price and business model

The proposed core price is **$100 as a one-time fee**, explicitly not a recurring subscription. This is a premium, event-driven purchase associated with a particular breakup and a concrete desired outcome. The optional Go Back restoration mode costs additional money; its amount has not been specified.

The founder specifically identified on-again/off-again relationships as a potential source of repeat transactions. People might pay for the initial cleanup, pay again to restore content following reconciliation, and potentially use the service again after another breakup. This is a proposed revenue dynamic, not a proven demand or conversion forecast.

3. What the user is emotionally buying

The founder's key insight is that someone in a painful breakup may want their ex erased from sight yet still crave a sliver of hope. Clean Slate lets them take action to stop seeing the relationship everywhere without necessarily making an irreversible emotional commitment to losing the memories forever.

The Go Back feature is therefore not a minor technical recovery utility. It is part of the appeal of buying Clean Slate in the first place. The product offers relief in the present while leaving open the possibility of restoring memories in the future. In simple terms: **distance without necessarily demanding finality.**

4. The Go Back feature: original design preserved

After the initial cleanup, a user who reconciles with their former partner can purchase Go Back Mode for an additional charge. Unlocking that restoration requires a unique password sent **automatically by email to the ex**, not directly to the paying user. The ex then communicates that password to the paying user, allowing restoration.

This recipient choice is intentional. It is meant to introduce a two-person step and to connect restoration with the possibility that the couple is back together. The founder does not want the email-to-ex mechanism removed or replaced merely because it is unconventional.

5. Why the ex receives the email

The founder believes a customer going through a difficult breakup will often enter their ex's real email address because part of them still hopes the relationship will resume. The address is not just a technical field; psychologically it may embody that lingering possibility. The app does not need to force the customer to confront this hope explicitly.

A fake address could be used to circumvent the two-person process. The founder's response is that this is not necessarily a commercial problem: the customer would still have paid for the original service and the additional restoration, and would be back where they started with the restored content. The founder does not consider preventing every possible workaround central to the product's value.

6. Why the email should be inconspicuous

The founder further clarified that the email need not plainly announce the relationship, breakup, or restoration. The original suggestion was that it could be intentionally disguised as ordinary spam, so it would be unlikely to attract attention on its own. The expected way for the ex to locate it is for the paying customer to tell them privately, through a trusted conversation, that a recovery email has been sent and where to look.

The intended sequence is: the couple reconnects; the original customer pays for Go Back; the ex receives an unobtrusive email containing the password; the customer tells the ex to find it; the ex shares the password; restoration is unlocked. The email itself is not intended to initiate contact or independently announce reconciliation.

A practical distinction discussed: possession of the password confirms access to that inbox and willingness to share it, but does not conclusively prove the relationship has resumed. Also, a message that resembles spam may be filtered or rejected by email systems. These are implementation considerations, not requests to discard the founder's mechanism.

7. AI-assisted cleanup route

Under the original approach, the app would help identify content tied to a particular ex across accessible photos, videos, media, messages, attachments and stored files. AI might recognize faces, names, dates, context or other relationship-related signals. The user would review and authorize how identified material is handled. The product promise is to reduce the effort of discovering forgotten material, not merely to provide another folder.

This approach could become more automated over time, subject to what the operating system and connected services actually permit. Full access to every iPhone app, private message store, cloud account and deeply buried attachment cannot be assumed.

8. Guided non-AI cleanup route

The founder subsequently questioned whether AI is even necessary. An alternative is an app that teaches users where relationship-related content tends to be hidden and walks them through locating it themselves. Users could then upload chosen files into the app or move them into a dedicated **Go Back folder** or vault.

The guided experience could cover obvious photo libraries and less-obvious locations such as hidden albums, downloads, message attachments, saved files, shared albums and cloud storage, where the user has access. It would explain where to look and how to move or remove items, rather than pretending the app can automatically inspect every service.

This manual approach is not a compromise that destroys the concept. It retains the core emotional proposition, the premium cleanup experience, and the paid password-gated restoration feature. AI and non-AI workflows could coexist as two routes to the same result; neither has been chosen as the exclusive final design.

9. What “removal” and “restoration” mean

The founder’s intent is for relationship reminders to disappear from the user’s everyday digital experience, with the possibility of bringing them back later. The precise storage design remains open. Candidate concepts discussed include uploading items to the app or transferring them to a dedicated Go Back folder or secure archive. The distinction between hiding, moving, archiving and permanently deleting is material because Go Back cannot restore content that no longer exists in any recoverable form.

The final product should clearly explain which content is actually removed from its original location, what is preserved for recovery, what the customer must do manually, and whether restoration can recreate the original organization. These details have not yet been decided.

10. What was debated, and the founder’s response

• **Concern:** Emailing an ex might be intrusive or expose private information. **Clarification:** The founder imagines an unobtrusive email, not an announcement, and expects the paying customer to alert the ex privately after reconciliation.

• **Concern:** The email does not prove reconciliation. **Clarification:** The intended product experience is a partner-mediated password exchange, not a formal legal or technical proof of relationship status.

• **Concern:** A fake email defeats the two-person step. **Clarification:** The founder does not view that as fatal; the customer still pays and receives restoration, and may choose to bypass the intended symbolism.

• **Concern:** Repeated breakups are an uncomfortable revenue driver. **Clarification:** The founder sees on/off relationships as a genuine repeat-purchase segment, while the central consumer appeal remains relief combined with a little hope.

• **Concern:** AI access to all phone content may be impossible. **Clarification:** The founder introduced a guided manual approach where users locate and upload or move their own material.

11. Illustrative customer journey

Breakup: A user buys Clean Slate for $100. They identify their former partner and choose either an AI-assisted search or a guided manual cleanup. Relevant content is collected, removed from normal view or otherwise handled according to the chosen workflow, with recoverable material retained for Go Back.

Time apart: The user experiences fewer unexpected reminders. They know there is a possibility of recovering memories, which may make the initial cleanup emotionally easier to accept.

Reconciliation: The user purchases the separately priced Go Back feature. A unique password is sent to the ex's email address. The paying user privately tells the ex to look for it. The ex shares the password, and the user unlocks restoration.

Another breakup, potentially: The user may choose to repeat cleanup, creating a possible repeat transaction. The exact pricing rules for subsequent cycles remain undecided.

12. Open product decisions — not changes to the concept

• What is the additional Go Back fee, and is it paid each time restoration is requested?

• Does the $100 purchase cover one ex, one cleanup event, or an account-wide period?

• Which material can be stored by the app, which must stay on-device, and which can only be handled with user guidance?

• How are very large video libraries and sensitive messages stored, protected and restored?

• How is the ex's email address collected and used, and how are delivery, privacy and consent handled without changing the intended password recipient?

• Does the initial release prioritize guided manual cleanup, AI-assisted cleanup, or both?

• What happens if an email is undeliverable or the former partner declines to provide the password?

13. Feasibility and trust considerations

The strongest feasibility question is not whether the concept can be explained; it is whether the app can reliably manage the kinds of content it promises to remove and later restore. On mobile platforms, permissions and app isolation limit automatic access to other apps' private data. Guided manual handling is therefore a plausible early product direction, while AI-assisted discovery may depend on approved photo-library access, user-selected files and supported integrations.

Because the app deals with intimate personal material, it would need unusually clear disclosure about storage, deletion, retention, access and recovery. Sending an email to an ex should not expose stored media or private relationship details. These are constraints to understand when assessing the idea, not a mandate to change the founder's chosen business model.

14. Positioning and summary for Claude

Clean Slate is a premium breakup-cleanup app built around a human contradiction: wanting an ex out of daily sight while still holding onto a possibility of getting back together. The core purchase is $100 once, with no subscription. Cleanup may be AI-assisted or guided and manual. Recoverable material is preserved through an app upload, Go Back folder, vault or other as-yet-undecided approach. If the relationship resumes, a separately paid Go Back mode restores the memories using a password automatically emailed to the ex, who shares it with the customer after a trusted private conversation.

Important interpretive note: Do not treat the ex-receives-the-password feature as an accidental flaw to silently replace. It is a deliberate element of the founder's emotional concept. Likewise, do not assume AI is required: the founder explicitly proposed a manual route. Questions about feasibility, trust and delivery can be raised clearly without rewriting the idea.

Status: Concept only. No market demand, willingness to pay, technical implementation, legal compliance, or restoration reliability has been validated in this conversation.

15. Definitive clarification: what the ex receives

The recovery email sent to the former partner contains **only a unique, randomly generated, meaningless password**. It does not contain any of the customer's stored content. No photographs, videos, messages, attachments, archives, files or relationship memories are emailed to the ex.

The message is intentionally inconspicuous. It need not explain the relationship, identify the content, or announce that the couple has reconciled. By itself, the password is a string of characters without useful context. The original customer privately tells their former partner to locate the email when they have reconciled and want to restore the content.

Intended sequence: The customer pays for Go Back Mode; the system generates a unique nonsense password; that password alone is emailed to the ex; the customer privately explains where to find it; the ex provides the password to the customer; and the customer enters it in Clean Slate to restore the customer's own retained content.

Access boundary: Receiving the email does not grant the ex access to the archive or allow the ex to retrieve, view or download the stored memories. Restoration happens in the original customer's account or device after the customer enters the password.

Reason this matters: The ex-receives-the-password design is meant to preserve a sliver of hope during the original breakup while creating a deliberate two-person step if reconciliation occurs. The email is a password-delivery mechanism, not a content-sharing mechanism or a standalone proof of reconciliation.

Instruction for interpreting this concept: This clarification supplements all preceding sections. Any reference in the earlier handoff to emailing a password must be understood as emailing the password **only**, never the underlying content. Preserve this distinction when discussing or evaluating the product.